

SHEKHAR DASH

Chapel Hill, NC | (+1) 919-951-8138

dshekhhar@unc.edu | to.cosmic.shekhhar@gmail.com | shekhhar@hateylekha.com

EDUCATION

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, USA

MA, Educational Innovation, Technology & Entrepreneurship (MEITE) – Specialization: Adaptive Learning Analytics (2026)

Satyajit Ray Film & Television Institute, Kolkata, India

3 Years Postgraduate Diploma in Cinema

Specialization: Direction & Screenplay Writing (2019)

(fully funded ICCR scholarship)

Visva Bharati University, Santiniketan, India

B.Mus (Hons), Drama and Theatre Arts (2012)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Mathematics Potential Lab (MPL) – UNC Chapel Hill

2025 – Present

- Special Education, Mathematical thinking

Analyst & Designer Intern, VER Coaching (VR Athlete Training) – Chapel Hill, NC

2025 – Present

- Analyze and visualize VR performance data

Graduate Research, MEITE Program – UNC Chapel Hill

2025 – Present

- *From Instruction to Interaction: Designing an Embodied, AI-Supported Learning Ecology* – ongoing project exploring how AI- and XR-mediated, embodied interactions can transform learning, integrating design-based research, learning analytics, and interaction analysis.

TEACHING & YOUTH MEDIA

Senior Instructor, Bangladesh Cinema and Television Institute – Dhaka

2023 – 2025 | Graduate Level

Adjunct Faculty, Dept. of Film & Television, Jagannath University – Dhaka

2022 – 2025 | Graduate & Undergraduate Level

Cultural Initiative Lead, Hatey Lekha

2024 – Present

Founder, Payntara – Youth Arts Initiative

2024 – Present

ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Managing Director, Cosmic Soup Ltd.

2023 – Present

Kancha – Agro Initiative – Dhaka, Bangladesh

2023 – Present

- Developing a platform for cluster-based farmer–retailer connections for vegetables, fruits, and fish in a fragmented agro-industry.
- Conducted informal market and stakeholder research with smallholders and retailers, highlighting the role of trust, information, and communication in adoption and coordination.

Rushpath – EdTech Initiative – Dhaka, Bangladesh

- Designed a game to teach C programming.
- Shortlisted for ICT Idea Grant and selected for a professional fellowship by the U.S. Department of State.

Founder & Creative Director, GEONICS – Dhaka
2013 – 2020

INDEPENDENT & CREATIVE WORK (selected)

Screenplay Writer & Director, Black Mirror Films – Dhaka. 2024 – Present

Screenplay Writer, Mars Solutions Limited – Dhaka. 2023

Post-Production Supervisor, Pandulipi Karkhana – Dhaka. 2021 – 2022

Screenplay Writer & Creative Producer, Data Solutions – Dhaka. 2021 – 2023

Studio Consultant, The Daily Samakal (Digital Content Studio) – Dhaka. 2021

SKILLS

Technical Skills

R, Python, Tableau, Flourish, Adobe Creative Cloud(Animate, PS, PP), Final Draft, AR/VR prototyping, 360-video production, Articulate 360, Figma

Soft / Conceptual Skills

Data analysis and visualization, Qualitative video analysis, Design-based research, Film (live action & animation) and theatre direction, Storytelling and narrative design, Curriculum design, Campaign design, Project management, Stakeholder communication, Team coordination

Languages

- Bengali (Native)
- English (Fluent – C1)